BSc Thesis Information

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Introduction and Schedule

Introduction

Welcome! On this website, you will be able to find all materials needed for the successful completion of your thesis.

This website was created by me, your supervisor - Lucija Sorić. It exists to simplify our workflows and offer a centralized platform that is easy to find (it is just one link!) and easy to share (still just one link!).

Some parts of this website are static, and unlikely to undergo major change. For example, contact details will always remain the same.

Other aspects, such as research materials, instructions, meeting summaries, and others, will be updated at the appropriate time. The Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ) section will be updated regularly, as more questions come in. This way, I am trying to ensure all of you can benefit from shared information, even if you were not the one to ask it.

Thanks for reading and looking forward to working with you!

Schedule

Below you can find the preliminary schedule. Upon changes, this will be updated.

For the sake of transparency, I have included both your tasks and my tasks in the schedule. If you want to see either one of them by itself, click the buttons below.

Show All

Student Only

Supervisor Only

Week	Dates	Student	Supervisor
1	31 Aug – 6 Sep	Topic selection, contact supervisor	Send website, plan meeting

Week	Dates	Student	Supervisor
2	7 Sep – 13 Sep	Group meeting 1, write proposal	Prepare research materials
3	14 Sep – 20 Sep	Write proposal	On holiday
4	21 Sep - 27 Sep	Write proposal	Prepare research materials
5	28 Sep - 4 Oct	Send proposal by **October 2 at 10:00**	
6	5 Oct - 11 Oct	Group meeting 2	Feedback on proposal
7	12 Oct - 18 Oct	Write intro. + method, collect data	
8	19 Oct - 25 Oct	Write intro. + method, collect data	
9	26 Oct - 1 Nov	Write intro. + method, send to supervisor by **November 2 at 10:00**, collect data	
10	2 Nov - 8 Nov	Plan analyses, collect data, group meeting #3	Feedback on intro. + method
11	9 Nov - 15 Nov	Send analysis plan to supervisor (optional)	Feedback on plan (optional)
12	16 Nov - 22 Nov	Data analysis	
13	23 Nov - 29 Nov	Analyses and write results	
14	30 Nov - 6 Dec	Analyses and write results	
15	7 Dec - 13 Dec	Hand in results by **December 7 at 21:00**	Feedback on results
16	14 Dec - 20 Dec	Write discussion	Feedback on results
17	21 Dec - 27 Dec	Write discussion	
18	28 Dec - 3 Jan	Write discussion + abstract	On holiday
19	4 Jan - 10 Jan	Hand in first full version by **January 8 at 21:00**	
20	11 Jan - 17 Jan	Work on final version	Feedback on 1st version
21	18 Jan - 24 Jan	Work on final version	

22	25 Jan - 31 Jan	Hand in final version

Part I

Thesis Process

Here, you can find all the information and materials needed to complete different sections of your thesis.

I will also share some tips for each aspect, as well as some general writing guidelines. However, do consult the thesis syllabus/student guide (click here) in order to ensure your sections are also in line with graded components.

1 Preparation

Our first meeting will be in the second week of September. In order for me to be able to plan the meeting and to ensure we are on track, I have prepared a to-do list of things you needed to do prior to our meeting.

1. Indicate your availability for the first meeting

   The meeting will be scheduled for 60-75 minutes during a time most of you are available. Please try to be **as flexible as possible**. You are working in a relatively large group, and unfortunately the scheduled time might not be the most optimal for all. If you cannot make the scheduled meeting, let me know.

2. Complete this questionnaire by **18:00** the day before our scheduled meeting. The questionnaire is anonymous (unless you wish to provide a name yourself).

3. Read the study description below once again. Think about which variables you find interesting and if you would like to add something to the study. If you have any questions, prepare them for the meeting.

4. Take a look at this website to understand its structure.

Project Description: Fall 26/27

Who Trusts Science? Personality, Politics, and Attitudes toward Science

Public trust in science shapes how people respond to scientific evidence and policy, but trust levels vary systematically by group. This is particularly true for those with certain political attitudes and worldviews (Gligorić et al., 2025). Gender, ethnicity, socioeconomic status and personality traits have also been identified as factors influencing levels of trust and attitudes towards science (Druckman et al., 2025; Fuglsang, 2024). Given ongoing societal changes such as the rise of the use of artificial agents, climate change, and political polarization, understanding what shapes individuals' responsiveness to science is increasingly important, since science informs the policies addressing these changes.

Students will collect survey-based data using validated self-report instruments, collecting data collaboratively with their group. Each student will select a subset of variables to test their own hypothesis about individual differences and trust in science.

Variables included: age, gender, political beliefs (various questionnaires), attitudes towards science (various questionnaires).

Variables that **can be added in case of interest**: attitudes towards women (e.g., manosphere beliefs), socioeconomic status, self-reported technology/artificial intelligence use, etc.

References

2 Proposal

A research proposal is one of the most important parts of a research project. It formulates a theoretical background and a specific plan you aim to follow.

Why do I need a research proposal?

Every project, academic or not, needs a plan. A research proposal is essentially a formalized, written plan of your future steps.

When doing academic research, there are often many roads you can take - or many ways a project can go. This is true for *any* project, too. For example, if you want to paint a wall, you can choose between many colors! However, some of these options are more logical than others. Maybe you do not like some of the colors, maybe some colors are not available, maybe some colors clash with the furniture you own… In order to move forward with your project you have to make some decisions (i.e., choose a color), and you have to be able to explain this decision (at least to yourself).

A research proposal helps you think ahead since it asks you to make certain decisions prior to starting. By completing this step, you will save your future self **a lot** of time.

How do I write a research proposal?

1. Read the literature previously shared with you.
2. Find a set of variables you are **genuinely** interested in exploring.
3. Think about the measures you can use **to research these variables**. Refer to the planned questionnaires and scales.
4. Do not plan to mix questionnaires into one variable, and do not split them up unless you have a good reason (or a published paper provided a good argument for it).
5. Formulate a research question and hypotheses with this set of variables.
6. Write all the plans up, together with all other parts of the proposal.

In practice, it takes a few tries to **complete the step 5.** It is likely that you will have to go through the steps 2-5 multiple times, each time reading more literature in order to improve your research question. This is **normal** and part of the process.

What do I include in a research proposal?

Please only follow the below guidelines when writing your proposal. The word count is an estimate, and you are welcome to go a bit over if needed. However, try to be as concise as possible while not losing important information.

There is no minimum or maximum amount of citations you should include. However, it is unlikely for the proposal to be written according to the guidelines without a substantial amount of citations.

Scientific background (~200 words)

Briefly describe the current state of the literature that led to your project idea. Provide definitions/descriptions of relevant concepts. Give more attention to a few key studies that directly address your research question.

Objectives & implications (~200 words)

Clearly describe the aims of your project. Describe how your research complements the current literature, or how it fits a gap. Argue why this is important to do. You can argue for real-life relevance, too, not just for scientific benefit. These should all follow from the previously described background. You can include your research question here.

Hypotheses (as many words as needed)

Formulate clear, specific hypotheses based on your research question. You can have multiple hypotheses, but you can also have just one - it is fully dependent on your question. For each hypothesis, state an expectation, explain how this expectation follows from previous literature.

An expectation needs to be *specific* - it is not enough to state you expect something to be different.

Example of a **bad** expectation:

I hypothesize I will/expect to find *a difference* in **trust in science** between the two groups.

Example of a **good** expectation:

I hypothesize I will/expect to find *lower scores* (this specifies the difference) on **questionnaires measuring beliefs in science** (this specifies the variable and the measure) in men compared to women (this specifies the direction of difference).*

* *This would be even better if you state the exact difference you expect. E.g., you expect to find scores that are at least 5 points lower. Remember:* ***be as specific as possible.***

Methods (~700 words)

For each section, provide a clear description and motivation for the choice made.

Design

Briefly address the study design (e.g., cross-sectional, longitudinal). State what type of measures will be used (e.g., self-reports) and where data collection will take place (e.g., online).

Participants

Indicate the expected characteristics of the sample, namely mention the sample size and the population you want to sample. The population will most likely be undergraduate students at Tilburg University. However, in case of availability, the population could focus on other groups (e.g., adults, specific genders, etc.). This is to be determined.

Measures

Describe each variable of your study, how it is measured, and what the expected output of the measure will be (e.g., a singular number, a score, a category). For questionnaires, include the name of the questionnaires, scale values (e.g., Likert scale from 1 to 5, with 1 =… , 2 = …), provide examples of questions. Always cite the original creator of the questionnaire. Provide psychometric data of questionnaires if available in previous work. The planned measures are listed here.

Statistical analysis

Program

Indicate the program and the version of the program you plan to use for your analyses. You can use any program you want, including SPSS and R. It is likely that all of you will use SPSS, but I can also guide you through analyses in other software.

Power

Execute and report a power analysis. This is an important step at this stage. You can use G*Power software. Provide a screenshot of the output you got.

Analysis

Indicate which statistical tests you will use, and describe the outcomes that would confirm or reject your hypothesis. The statistical test you choose has to be able to answer your hypothesis. If you are in doubt, reach out - or change your research question.

It is possible your research question may need a statistical method you are not yet familiar with. In that case you **have to** change your research question. Be mindful of the questions that can be answered with your current statistical knowledge. It is always better to have correct but simple analyses instead of incorrect but complicated ones.

How do I format the proposal?

Use the standard formatting: APA-style, Times New Roman, 12-point font, line spacing 2.0. Include page numbers.

Deadline and submission

The deadline for the completed proposal is **October 2 at 10:00.**

The proposal is submitted through email to me. This is the official way to submit it.

Questions

If you have any questions regarding the choice of variables, your research question, hypotheses, power, or analyses - **please reach out**.

In this orienting stage of the project, I will not be strict about the emails you send me, and they will not be counted for the official correspondence limit. However, my response times remain the same, so please plan ahead.

3 Introduction

Scientific writing is storytelling, not an administrative report. In your story, the introduction serves as the first chapter. It exists to convince the reader of the importance of the topic and justifies your research.

How do I tell a story?

Order matters

In any sort of storytelling, there is a "logical" way to do things. When you watch a movie, it is very unlikely that the biggest battle, the saddest conversation, or the biggest journey will happen right at the beginning. (Unless the filmmaker *really* likes to experiment.)

Instead, stories start with a "hook", something that draws you in - followed by sentences that put that hook into context.

In scientific writing, the order is quite similar. If you do not do this right, your reader might lose interest. After all, do not we all have a book we just *cannot* get into?

Order in Scientific Writing

You start with a **hook of sorts** followed by a general **topic introduction**. This topic introduction is put into context through a **literature review** where you show what we know now, what we could know, and why this matters. Finally, you **show how your work helps us know more**.

Content matters

We as a society know a lot - but we also do not know even more. There are many things to learn or discover. Would it not be cool to solve a disease, help a certain group of people, stop climate change, or find a new planet?

Unfortunately it is **very** unlikely your thesis can do even a fraction of a discovery of such magnitude. This makes sense, a bachelor's thesis is a part-time endeavor over a few months, with a focus on skill-gaining - not discovery.

Content in Scientific Writing

Important to:

- not use **strong claims**
- not **oversell your research**

Remember: scientific storytelling is based on reality not fiction. Honesty and transparency are crucial.

Style matters

Style (in scientific writing) refers to *how* something is written, rather than *what* is written. It is an important, often ignored element of writing a good paper or a thesis.

When reading a paper, style is usually the first thing a reader notices. They notice 1) the **general structure of the paper** that might not be self-chosen, and 2) the **individual's writing style**.

Structure

Here, structure refers to the way a paper is organized. This might be imposed by journal's standards, or industry standards (such as APA). For example, it indicates where a section will be, if a sub-section will have a sub-heading, how things will be cited, how figures are named, etc.

In a bachelor's thesis structure expectations are clearly stated, and usually follow the program's general standard - such as with the APA.

Individual style

Individual style is less strictly defined, but it adds to the reading experience even more than the structure. It refers to the way e.g., a writer structures sentences, types of words they use, length of sentences, use of commas, etc.

Despite the subjectivity of this style, there are certain expectations, and certain rules a scientific writer needs to follow. Below I share some stylistic tips and suggestions.

Use simple, commonly understood words and phrases. These words, or phrases, are commonly found in student papers and are often included in AI generated writing. However, more complicated **does not** equal better.

For example:

- individuals -> people

- employ, utilize -> use
- acquire -> get
- consequently -> so

Such as **redundant word pairs or unnecessary modifiers**:

- end result -> result
- unexpected surprise -> surprise
- brief summary -> summary
- close proximity -> proximity

In these examples, the removed word *does not add* any additional meaning to the final word. Result, by definition, is an end-point of a process. Surprises are by definition unexpected. A summary is by definition brief, and something in proximity is by definition close by.

Another example is the usage of wordy phrases:

- due to the fact that -> because
- at this point in time -> now

These examples simplify 5-word-phrases into one word without losing any meaning.

Try cutting sentences into halves, or thirds to improve readability.

- adverbs such as *basically, essentially* do not add much
- evaluative adjectives such as *important, interesting* add subjectivity that you should avoid
- intensifiers such as *very, really, highly* may make you oversell your research

Smith (2017) found that water is wet. -> Water is wet (Smith, 2017).

Authors should only be mentioned narratively if their work is integral part of your study, and you will be actively contributing to their ideas directly and/or when a paper is a foundational study.

Flow matters

In literary and cinematic storytelling, there are *many* stories with non-standard structures. Novels that combine present and past, movies that combine conscious and subconscious, or TV-shows that combine reality and dreams - I am sure you all can name at least one. While many of these may be masterpieces, **many** media consumers still find them confusing, odd, or complicated.

Unlike artistic storytelling, scientific storytelling **cannot** rely on emotional and perceptive experiences, openness to ambiguity, and differential interpretations. It leaves very little room for experimentation in structure or word, and mostly relies on logical, uninterrupted sequences.

Flow in Scientific Writing

Important that:

- paragraphs **naturally flow** from one another
- literature is **integrated** within the larger structure of the section

This means that often times, if you want to study e.g., the development of cognitive abilities in children, the usual structure of: 1) introduce and define cognitive abilities [interruption] 2) introduce development of abilities [interruption] 3) connect the two - might not be ideal.

Instead it could be integrated differently, by for example talking about development of abilities, and using cognitive abilities as an instance of such.

"Proof" matters

Have you ever seen a courtroom drama where a new piece of evidence gets discovered and the entire room becomes chaos? While such scenes might not fully mirror the real world, they do show that **evidence changes things.**

It is unlikely your sentences will succeed at convincing a reader without evidence. Without evidence, a reader cannot distinguish opinion from fact.

It is also possible that your reader might feel cheated if you do not provide evidence. In scientific writing, it is possible that your reader was in fact the one that found something. Without showing evidence of these findings, you might be incorrectly attributing the findings to yourself.

Failing to show evidence might also weaken your arguments, even if they are (in theory) excellent! Perhaps there is a niche finding that justifies your research perfectly - without evidence, this finding seems like a speculation.

"Proof" in Scientific Writing

Important to:

- **correctly reference and cite** all literature that supports your ideas
- cite **right articles** - classics, reviews, recent work
- **show importance of previous work when building your arguments**

Materials

Here you can find all the digital materials needed for your project. This page will be updated periodically.

Measures

You can download the descriptions of the planned measures here. For each measure, listed are: the name of the measure, the reference to the work that first introduced it, and how you can access the measure to observe the items.

Part II

Group Meetings

Meeting 1

Date: September 11, 2026

Time: 13:00 - 14:15

Location: Simon building, room S1

Before the meeting

How to find the room?

The room is located on the **ground floor** of the Simon building. If you enter from Professor Verbernelaan, on the right you will see an entrance with a staircase, two elevators and a door. Go through that door and then through the hallway on the right. The room will be the first one on the right.

What if I cannot attend?

Immediately following the meeting, a **meeting summary and the PDF of the presentation will be shared here**. If you cannot attend the meeting, let me know. If the PDF of the presentation is not enough to understand everything, we can schedule an individual meeting on some other day so you can ask questions. This meeting would not count as one of the individual feedback meetings, do not worry.

Do I have to prepare anything?

Everything you need to do to prepare for the meeting has already been shared here.

After the meeting

Meeting slides

You can download the slides here.

Meeting summary

- Introduced ourselves.
- Briefly discussed the topic.
- Explained the topic, mentioned that data collection is done collaboratively, and that population has to be agreed upon by the group.
- Went over the research proposal assignment.
- Mentioned that students are free to add variables, but that they have to find the measure they want to use and explain why.
- Next steps for **students**: think of a research question, keep adjusting ideas, reach out if stuck, and finally submit the proposal.
- Next steps for **supervisor**: plan next meeting in the week of 5th of October, share the questionnaires that will be included, help students with proposal if needed.

Meeting 2

Date: October 9, 2026

Time: 14:00 - 15:15

Location: Simon building, room S1

Before the meeting

How to find the room?

The room is located on the **ground floor** of the Simon building. If you enter from Professor Verbernelaan, on the right you will see an entrance with a staircase, two elevators and a door. Go through that door and then through the hallway on the right. The room will be the first one on the right.

What if I cannot attend?

Immediately following the meeting, a **meeting summary and the PDF of the presentation will be shared here**. If you cannot attend the meeting, let me know.

Do I have to prepare anything?

By this date, you will have already submitted and received feedback on your proposal. If you have any questions regarding the feedback, you can prepare them for the meeting. For the meeting itself, you need to prepare a **short** presentation about your proposal.

Presentation guidelines

- 1 slide, or an image
- visually include the **research question**, a **graphical** hypothesis (e.g., if you are comparing two groups you can show an expected difference in scores with a *hypothetical* bar plot, or if you want to do a mediation analysis you should show a mediation model with expected directions of cause such as x increases y) and **one key argument** (e.g., important finding from a paper)
- verbally prepare to explain your idea by shortly introducing us to the background, indicating the research question and walking us through your hypothesis
- the presentation should last 2-3 minutes, if not less
- please **share your slide/image with me by 13:00 on that Friday** so I can present them on the screen in the meeting room

After the meeting

Meeting slides

You can download the slides here.

Meeting summary

- Gave some general feedback about proposals.
- Explained some APA rules about **citations, abbreviations, capitalization**.
- Students presented their proposals.
- Presented "the funnel", some tips about starting.
- Went over some **openers** for a scientific paper.
- Introduced a reference manager (Zotero) and briefly demonstrated how it can be used within the thesis process. A link for a 10-minute tutorial is shared in the slides.
- Shared some tips about writing the methods section.
- Finished with an overview of the upcoming tasks and deadlines.

Meeting 3

Immediately following the meeting, a meeting summary and the PDF of the presentation will be shared here.

Individual Meetings

After receiving written feedback on different parts of your thesis, you can book a meeting to further discuss the feedback in person.

These meetings are optional, but ***highly recommended***. In the meeting, you can ask about anything you find unclear about the feedback, something you wanted feedback on but did not get, advice, etc.

You can also use these opportunities to ask any other questions you might have, such as issues with motivation, special circumstances, etc.

Booking Link and Location

Link

Please use this link to book the meetings: https://tidycal.com/l-soric.

This way, you can book any time slot you want*, and you do not have to let me know of your intention to do so.

* *I will add more time slots every week. In case there are no available time slots, wait a few days before letting me know.*

Location

By default, all booked meetings are **in person**. Upon booking, I will let you know where exactly (i.e., which building/room) we will be meeting. However, in case of special circumstances, you can let me know to move the meeting online. There is an option to do so during the booking process. In case of my own special circumstances, I will let you know ASAP about the change in plans.

Number of Meetings

You are allowed to book **three** (3) meetings to discuss written thesis feedback. However, if you would like to discuss anything else regarding the thesis process - that is not directly related to your written work - *please feel free to book additional meetings.*

Length of Meetings

Feedback meeting are expected to last 45 minutes. However, in case you already know you do not have a lot of questions, you can book a 30 minute meeting instead. Alternatively, in case you already know that you might need *more* time, you can book two back-to-back 30 minute meetings. These will count as **one** (1) meeting.

Thesis Guidelines

Thesis guidelines are freely available on Canvas. For simplicity, you can find the link to the files below.

To open the correct file, please click on the name of your major:

Economic Psychology

Social Psychology

Work and Organisational Psychology

On Canvas you can also find the grading rubric, under the Thesis Assessment module. It is ***highly recommended*** that you take a look at this while writing different sections of your thesis, since you are graded based on this.

Contact Details

Email

For all questions and inquiries, please use the email below:

l.soric@tilburguniversity.edu

What to Include in Thesis-related Emails?

It is important to include as much detail as possible so that the back-and-forth exchange is limited and you get an adequate response as soon as possible.

For example, if your question is related to certain sections, for each section you can include:

- **Introduction:** relevant context, references, what you already have, what you need…
- **Methods:** what you have done so far, what options you considered…
- **Results:** what you want to achieve, what you did to get there, what you would like me to do to help you…
- **Discussion:** relevant context, references, arguments you are unsure about…

This list is not exhaustive, and can vary per needs. However, in all thesis-related exchanges make sure to highlight **what you have tried so far** and **what you need help with.** If you have not tried anything yet, it is likely my response would not be sufficient to solve your problem.

Contact Frequency

Thesis-related

To ensure fairness, there is a limited amount of times you can contact me for **urgent, thesis-related matters.**

- *Urgent* means that it cannot wait until the next meeting/feedback point.

- *Thesis-related* means that it has to do with a certain section of the thesis, the thesis process, thesis rules, etc. Almost all information you might need is freely available to you on Canvas or on this website.

For this type of contact, you can contact me up to 6-7 times. Do know that I will not be counting these emails unless I notice a disproportionate amount of contact points*.

* *A contact point refers to the **entire** email exchange. If my response is not clear, please feel free to ask for clarification. This is not considered a separate contact point.*

Not thesis-related

Please note that there are **no limits** on emails that have to do with e.g., booking a meeting, personal issues (such as sickness, family issues, mental health issues,...), procedural issues (e.g., if you cannot open a link on this website). You are free to contact me whenever.

Reply frequency

The supervision time allocated to me is *limited*. This means that apart from supervision, I have additional responsibilities with their own deadlines. Therefore, you can expect to receive a reply **any time within 5 working days***. I will likely reply a lot sooner, but keep this in mind when planning your work. For example, if you only start working on a section a few days before the deadline and get stuck, it is possible you will not be able to get help on time.

* *If it has been longer than this, and I am not on holiday, please send me a reminder. However, sending reminders too early is prohibited and could affect your final thesis grade (namely, the work attitude section in the rubric).*

Meetings

If you want to book a meeting, please click here to learn how to do so.

FAQ

Process

Content

Special circumstances

Druckman, J. N., Ognyanova, K., Safarpour, A., Schulman, J., Lunz Trujillo, K., Uslu, A. A., Green, J., Baum, M. A., Quintana-Mathé, A., Qu, H., Perlis, R. H., & Lazer, D. M. J. (2025). Representation in science and trust in scientists in the USA. *Nature Human Behaviour*, *10*(3), 476–491. https://doi.org/10.1038/s41562-025-02358-4

Fuglsang, S. (2024). What if some people just do not like science? How personality traits relate to attitudes toward science and technology. *Public Understanding of Science*, *33*(5), 623–633. https://doi.org/10.1177/09636625231220341

Gligorić, V., Kleef, G. A. van, & Rutjens, B. T. (2025). Political ideology and trust in scientists in the USA. *Nature Human Behaviour*, *9*(7), 1501–1512. https://doi.org/10.1038/s41562-025-02147-z